Adding Dumpster Rental to Your Existing Business: A Side Hustle That Scales

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The best businesses aren't always built from scratch. Sometimes the most profitable move is adding a revenue stream to infrastructure you already have.

Dumpster rental is uniquely well-suited to this approach. If you run a service business with trucks, employees, and local customers — you're already most of the way there.

Who This Is For

This article is for owners of:

- Landscaping companies
- Construction and renovation contractors
- Junk removal businesses
- Water services and utility operations

- Hauling and delivery businesses
- Any business with heavy-duty trucks and hourly employees

If you have trucks that aren't fully utilized every day, and employees whose schedules have gaps, adding dumpster rental to your operation can generate meaningful revenue from assets that are already paid for.

The Gerald Scogin Model

Gerald runs a water services company in southwestern Pennsylvania. His primary business does $300,000 to $400,000 per month in revenue. He has 15 trucks, a mix of salaried and hourly employees, and significant operational infrastructure.

He started his dumpster rental operation two months before we spoke with him. His reasoning was simple: "The dumpsters are just another form of a way to keep people busy."

He bought 6 bumper pull containers in 13-yard size, specifically because they could be pulled by trucks he already owned. His entire equipment investment: roughly $20,000 to $25,000.

Two months in: 4 dumpsters going out every week. He's averaging roughly $5,600 to $7,000 per month in additional revenue — from employees and trucks that would otherwise be partially idle.

His plan if it scales: "If you can get us enough work for 50 boxes, I'll go buy 50 boxes. I have the funding." His dumpster business started as a way to keep hourly employees busy. It's becoming a real second revenue line.

The Michael Pires Model

Michael runs a landscaping company that evolved into dumpster rental through his customer relationships. When the communities he served began requesting dumpsters, he built the service to meet that demand. What started as a convenience for his landscaping clients became 21 dumpsters, two trucks, and a side business generating meaningful revenue.

His situation: the dumpster business is real but the second truck isn't fully utilized. He needs more consistent demand to justify both trucks running every day. The landscaping operation provides cover — it's not existential if the dumpster side has a slow week. But he wants the dumpster business to stand on its own.

This is the common arc: start as an add-on, grow until it deserves to be treated as a standalone business.

The Bumper Pull Advantage

For operators with existing trucks, the bumper pull trailer approach changes the economics dramatically.

Standard roll-off trucks cost $35,000 to $65,000 used. Most businesses don't have one — and buying one as a first step into dumpster rental represents a significant capital commitment before you've proven any demand.

Bumper pull trailers attach to heavy-duty pickup trucks or work trucks you already own. They cost $5,000 to $12,000 and handle containers up to 14 to 16 yards — the size range that serves most residential jobs.

Example cost comparison:

Approach	Equipment Cost	Trucks Needed
Traditional roll-off entry	$50,000 to $70,000	Buy dedicated roll-off truck
Bumper pull (using existing truck)	$18,000 to $30,000	Use what you have

For a business that already has trucks, the bumper pull approach reduces startup cost by 60 to 70% while serving the majority of residential demand.

How Your Existing Customers Become Your First Revenue

The fastest path to your first dumpster jobs isn't advertising — it's your existing client base.

If you run a landscaping company, your customers are already doing outdoor projects. A backyard renovation, a patio installation, a big cleanup — all of these generate debris that needs somewhere to go.

Send a simple message to your current clients: "We now offer dumpster rental. If your next project generates debris you need removed, let us handle it — just add it to your project."

This cross-sell doesn't require marketing. It doesn't require Google Ads or SEO. It converts an existing service relationship into an additional revenue transaction. And customers who book you for both services are more loyal than customers who only use one.

The same principle applies to any service business: your current customers know you, trust you, and are already paying you. Offering an adjacent service to them is always the lowest-friction starting point.

Building It Into a Standalone Business

Most operators who add dumpster rental to an existing business start by treating it as a supplemental income line. That's fine — and it's often the right pace for the first 6 to 12 months.

But the operators who maximize the opportunity eventually give the dumpster business its own attention:

- Its own marketing budget and channels
- Its own utilization tracking and financial reporting
- Its own customer base beyond the cross-sell from the primary business
- Its own growth trajectory

This transition typically happens around 10 to 15 containers, when the dumpster revenue becomes significant enough to justify managing it as a real business unit rather than a side operation.

The Revenue Upside at Scale

Starting with 6 containers and growing to 20 over 18 months:

Stage	Containers	Jobs/Month	Monthly Revenue
Month 1 to 3	6	15 to 20	$6,000 to $8,000
Month 6	10	35 to 45	$14,000 to $18,000
Month 12	15	55 to 70	$22,000 to $28,000
Month 18	20	75 to 90	$30,000 to $36,000

At 40 to 50% margins, month 18 net contribution: $12,000 to $18,000/month.

From equipment that cost $50,000 to $75,000 all-in and leveraged infrastructure you already had. The payback period on the equipment investment: typically 6 to 9 months.

What to Watch Out For

Don't let the existing business subsidize a poorly run dumpster operation. If the dumpster side isn't generating margin within 3 to 4 months, figure out why — marketing problem, pricing problem, or operational problem — before throwing more capital at it.

Keep the businesses separate financially. Even if they share trucks and employees, track the dumpster business P&L separately from day one. You need to know if it's actually profitable on its own terms.

Don't over-leverage your existing operation. If adding dumpster jobs is straining your primary business's scheduling, communication, or customer service, the cross-subsidy is going the wrong direction.

Build marketing for the dumpster business independently. The cross-sell from your existing customers is a great start — but it has a ceiling. To grow beyond that ceiling, the dumpster business needs its own Google presence, its own reviews, and its own customer acquisition channels.

Ready to talk through how dumpster rental could fit into your existing operation? Book a free strategy call at dumpsterflow.com.